

F6 English SP — Lesson 6 (DSE 2013 Paper 1 Part B2)

TEACHER'S VERSION & ANSWER KEY WITH EXPLANATIONS

Reading: Part B2 · Text 4 “The Triumph of Dystopian Literature” (the boom in dystopian fiction for young readers) · 6 questions = 15 marks

Focus skill: cloze / gap-fill questions — complete a summary of one paragraph with ONE word in each blank.

This key follows the revised student handout page for page: Part A (vocabulary), Part B (the tip + the demo slide), Part C (the 6 exam questions). Every answer keeps the marking scheme's own wording, and the % in brackets is the % of 2013 candidates awarded that mark (HKEAA marking scheme).

Part A Key vocabulary (Answer Key)

Match each word or phrase with the correct definition (A–J). Write the letter in the answer column.

No.	Word / phrase	Answer	Definition
1	authoritarian (Line 4)	I	demanding total obedience; allowing no personal choice
2	oppressive (Line 5)	G	treating people in a harsh and controlling way
3	conform (Line 45)	H	to behave in the same way as everyone else; to follow a fixed standard
4	conducive (Line 22)	C	making something more likely to happen; helpful for
5	trilogy (Line 25)	B	a set of three connected books, films or plays
6	cliff-hanger (Line 52)	F	an exciting ending that leaves readers unsure what happens next
7	façade (Line 93)	J	an outward appearance that hides the truth
8	utopia (Line 93)	A	an imagined perfect world, in which everything is good
9	didactic (Line 140)	D	written to teach a moral lesson
10	extinction (Line 117)	E	the state of no longer existing; being completely destroyed

Answers: 1-I · 2-G · 3-H · 4-C · 5-B · 6-F · 7-J · 8-A · 9-D · 10-E

Two words worth a minute of class time: conducive (C) is an adjective that goes with “to” (“less conducive to adventure”), and conform (H) is a verb — so it can never fill a blank that needs an adjective. Utopia (8-A) sits in the list next to the passage's own word dystopia, and the two are opposites.

Part B Exam tip — how to complete “cloze” (gap-fill) questions

The tip box below is exactly what is on the student handout and on PPT slide 4 — read it with the class before you show the demo.

Two possible instructions

- Complete the blanks with a word/phrase from Paragraph ...
- Complete the blanks with the information from Paragraph ... Make sure the answers are grammatical.

How to answer?

- Find key words around the blank (Idea) – watch out for synonyms
- Check word form (Grammar) – watch out for ending of the word

Say it like this:

“The blank is part of a SUMMARY of one paragraph, and the summary is a paraphrase — the words around the blank are almost never the words in the text. Do not hunt for the summary’s own word. Hunt for the IDEA, then copy the text’s word and fix its ending.”

The two instructions tell students what kind of answer to expect:

- “...a word/phrase from Paragraph X” → the word is printed in that paragraph: lift it, then check the form.
- “...the information from Paragraph X” → the idea has to change shape to fit the blank (a noun → a verb, an adjective → a noun, “eleventh” → “eleven”).

Check the words AROUND the blank before writing:

a / an + _____ = noun • a higher _____ = adjective + noun • more _____ = adjective (comparative) • the _____ book = ordinal • some time in the _____ = noun • was / were _____ by = past participle • are _____ how to ... = past participle • they also _____ = base verb (no -s) • grew _____ = adverb (-ly) • shown _____ = preposition phrase (two words) • the sole survivor _____ = verb

A wide blank or a pair of blanks usually means a fixed pair of words printed in the text — “crime rate”, “outdoor arena”, “on television”. Both words must be written.

The demo slide — ONE paragraph, FOUR questions (PPT slide 5)

The paragraph stays on screen; the four questions sit below it, two easier on the top row and two harder on the bottom row. Click order on the slide: click 1 = the red reminder strip at the top right (“Find key words around the blanks (Idea) / Check word form (Grammar)”), then one click per answer — each answer appears in green, sitting on its blank.

(demo — a made-up paragraph, not from the examination paper)

Harry Potter and its Philosopher’s Stone is a debut novel written by J.K. Rowling. Set in modern-day Scotland, it follows a young orphan boy who discovers his magical heritage on his eleventh birthday. He is enrolled in Hogwarts School, a hidden school where young wizards train. Throughout the year, students attend classes to learn spell-casting and potion-making, while doing house competitions.

Demo 1 — EASIER (one word)

Q: The story follows a young boy without parents who discovers his wizard identity when he turns (i) _____ .

Answer: **eleven** // **11** • green on the slide

Teaching move: The form changes: the paragraph says “his eleventh birthday”, but after “turns” the blank needs a number. Many students will write “eleventh” — show them why the ending decides the mark.

Demo 2 — EASIER (one word, an adjective)

Q: He is sent to a (ii) _____ institution that trains young wizards.

Answer: **hidden** · green on the slide

Teaching move: “a _____ institution” = adjective, and the paragraph gives it word for word (“a hidden school”). “Magic” or “secret” are fair ideas but not the text’s word.

Demo 3 — HARDER (one word, verb form)

Q: During his time at Hogwarts, students are (iii) _____ how to cast spells and make potions.

Answer: **taught** · green on the slide

Teaching move: “are _____ how to ...” = past participle. The paragraph only says “students attend classes to learn”, so the idea has to be reshaped: the classes teach them.

Demo 4 — HARDER (one word, base verb)

Q: They also (iv) _____ against each other in house events.

Answer: **compete** · green on the slide

Teaching move: “They also _____” = base verb, no -s. The paragraph’s noun (“while doing house competitions”) becomes a verb in the blank — the neatest example of the “idea first, then the word form” routine.

Pre-class glance: the demo paragraph reads “Harry Potter and its Philosopher’s Stone” — the title is “Harry Potter and the Philosopher’s Stone”.

Part C Cloze / gap-fill and short-answer questions — the exercise (15 marks)

The 6 questions from DSE 2013 Paper 1 Part B2 (Text 4), in passage order and in the wording of the revised student handout. The two cloze items are broken down blank by blank, in the order the answers appear on the slide (one click each).

Q1. (DSE Q47) What does “it” (line 6) refer to? (1 mark, 88%)

Answer: **dystopia**

What to say when you click: “Read backwards — find the noun before “it”.” ¶1: “Dystopia is an imaginary place or condition in which everything is bad... For young readers, dystopia isn’t a future to be averted; it is a version of what’s already happening in the world they inhabit.” → “it” = dystopia.

Slide: 1 click; the red oval marks the proof word in the passage crop.

Evidence: Text 4, ¶1 — the key sentence is line 6.

Q2. (DSE Q48) Based on the information given in paragraph 2, complete the text by writing ONE word to fill in each blank. You should make sure that your answers are grammatically correct, paying attention to word form, plurals etc. (5 marks, 91 / 78 / 74 / 59 / 45%)

Answer: (i) Rebecca Stead • (ii) crime rate • (iii) freedom // autonomy // adventure • (iv) safer • (v) protected // controlled

(i) **Rebecca Stead** • 91% • two words, both needed (a name). ¶2: “Rebecca Stead chose to set her children’s novel When You Reach Me ... partly because that’s where she grew up.”

(ii) **crime rate** • 78% • the two-part blank is the hint: the text prints the pair — “a significant drop in New York’s crime rate”.

(iii) **freedom // autonomy // adventure** • 74% • any one of the three is accepted: “a great deal of autonomy” / “a rare freedom in today’s city” / “less conducive to adventure”.

(iv) **safer** • 59% • after “is” an adjective is needed: “The world of our hovered-over teens and preteens may be safer, but it’s also less conducive to adventure.”

(v) **protected // controlled** • 45% • the hardest blank. The clue is “hovered-over teens” — children whose parents watch over them. “safe” will not do: the blank needs a past participle (“by their parents”).

Click by click: five clicks, one per blank, in order (i) → (v). The lilac card on this slide shows only the marks and percentages, so the word-class talk is yours: noun → adjective → noun → adjective → past participle.

Evidence: Text 4, ¶2 (lines 9–23).

Q3. (DSE Q51) Based on the information in paragraph 3, complete the book synopsis of The Hunger Games by writing ONE word to fill in each blank. You should make sure that your answers are grammatically correct, paying attention to word form, plurals, etc. (6 marks, 24 / 21 / 68 / 88 / 38 / 46%)

Answer: (i) first • (ii) future • (iii) each • (iv) outdoor arena • (v) on television // TV • (vi) wins // lives

(i) **first** • 24% • the hardest blank of the two cloze items. The text calls Mockingjay “the third installment in the trilogy”, so The Hunger Games is the first book. “the _____ book” = an ordinal — “one” or “third” both miss the mark.

(ii) **future** • 21% • “some time in the _____” needs a noun; the text says “a futuristic North America”, so the adjective has to become the noun “future”.

(iii) **each** • 68% • “Two children from (iii) _____ district” — the district is singular, and the text says “two children from each district”.

(iv) **outdoor arena** • 88% • the easiest blank in the set: the text prints the pair, “held in a huge outdoor arena”.

(v) **on television // TV** • 38% • two blanks = two words. The text says “televised contest”, and “shown” needs a preposition first: “shown on television”.

(vi) **wins // lives** • 46% • “The sole survivor _____.” needs a verb: the text says “The winner of the contest is the last child left alive”, so “wins” or “lives”. “is alive” breaks the ONE-word rule.

Click by click: six clicks, one per blank, in order (i) → (vi).

Evidence: Text 4, ¶3 (lines 24–38).

Q4. (DSE Q55) What does the simile “like a wicked strain of the flu” (lines 68–69) suggest about the book *The White Mountains*? (1 mark, 23%)

Answer: the interest in dystopian novels for young-adult readers spread very quickly // the book was infectious // it was popular / a big hit (among teens / among her classmates)

Three answers are accepted. ¶5: “The White Mountains ... tore through my own sixth-grade classroom like a wicked strain of the flu.” A flu spreads fast and hits everyone — so did the book. The answer is the shared quality, never “because they are similar”.

What to say when you click: “What is common between the book and a flu?”

Evidence: Text 4, ¶5 (lines 65–70).

Q5. (DSE Q59) In paragraph 7, find a word which means “a major disaster”. (1 mark, 69%)

Answer: catastrophe // apocalypse

Both words are accepted. ¶7: “...our errors and delusions may lead to catastrophe, but if ... a new, better way of life can be assembled from the ruins, would the apocalypse really be such a bad thing?”

What to say when you click: “Look for a NOUN — and do not write ‘disaster’.” The answer must be the word printed in ¶7; “disaster” is the clue, not the answer.

Evidence: Text 4, ¶7 (lines 120–124).

Q6. (DSE Q62) What does “this” (line 139) refer to? (1 mark, 18%)

Answer: children not having control in the world // (children) don’t run the world

The hardest item in the set (18%). ¶9: “Children, however, don’t run the world, and teenagers, especially, feel the sting of this.”

What to say when you click: “Read back to the subject of the paragraph.” The paragraph’s subject is children having no control — that is the sting.

Evidence: Text 4, ¶9 (lines 137–140).

Marks at a glance: Q2 (5) + Q3 (6) = 11 of the 15 marks come from the two cloze items — the tip and the demo are worth the lesson time.

Timing suggestion: vocabulary 8–10 min · tips + demo 15 min · Q1–Q6 25 min · whole-class feedback 5 min.

Three small things for a glance before class (deck housekeeping): (1) the tips text reveals twice on slide 4 (clicks 1–2 for the instructions, 3–4 for “How to answer”) — the second click of each pair does nothing; (2) the speaker notes on slide 4 still describe Lesson 5’s metaphor / simile clicks — worth rewriting to the cloze routine; (3) the demo paragraph’s title should read “Harry Potter and the Philosopher’s Stone”.